

# Davi Doneda Mittelstadt

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## Education

### University of Wisconsin-Madison

PHD IN ECONOMICS

- Major: Industrial Organization. Committee: Jean-François Houde, Kenneth Hendricks, Karam Kang

Madison/WI, United States

Aug. 2021 - 2027 (expected)

### Pontifical Catholic University - Rio de Janeiro (PUC-Rio)

MSC ECONOMICS

- Thesis: Local Content in Brazilian Oil and Gas Auctions (Advisor: Prof. Leonardo Rezende)

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Jan. 2017 - Aug. 2019

### Federal University of Rio Grande do Sul (UFRGS)

BA IN ECONOMICS

### Federal University of Rio Grande do Sul (UFRGS)

BA IN INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Porto Alegre, Brazil

Mar. 2011 - Dec. 2012

Porto Alegre, Brazil

Mar. 2007 - Dec. 2010

## Job Market Paper

### Asymmetric Information and Search Frictions in Auto Loans

WITH BERNARDUS VAN DOORNIK (CENTRAL BANK OF BRAZIL)

- Conferences: CEA 2026, North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society 2026, EARIE 2026

**Abstract:** We estimate a structural model of endogenous search and loan size choice to quantify how asymmetric information and search frictions jointly distort the auto loan market. Using administrative data from the Central Bank of Brazil, we observe the universe of loan contracts and, crucially, the specific set of lenders contacted by each borrower. Empirically, we find evidence of adverse selection on the intensive margin: borrowers who demand more credit are significantly riskier. Using instrumental variables, we show that this correlation is not driven by moral hazard, but by adverse selection. Furthermore, borrowers who search more are riskier and face higher interest rates, indicating that riskier borrowers have more incentives to search. On the demand side of our model, borrowers choose loan size and search intensity, with private information over their search costs and willingness to pay. Car dealers can supply quotes at no search cost to the borrower, which shapes how much they search on their own. Riskier borrowers select into search because their higher reservation rates expose them more to rate dispersion. On the supply side, we allow asymmetric lenders to compete over rates with non-linear menus depending on the loan size. Our estimates show that allowing lenders to perfectly observe consumers' private information would increase originations and borrowing. Larger loans make search more attractive, reducing average rates in equilibrium, given that search costs are high. Borrowers also derive significant surplus from the intermediation provided by car dealers, as most of the spread over a frictionless benchmark is the cost of a thin consideration set.

## References

### Jean-François Houde

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### Kenneth Hendricks

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University of Wisconsin-Madison  
hendrick@ssc.wisc.edu

### Karam Kang

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University of Wisconsin-Madison  
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## Research Fields

Industrial Organization, Banking, Household Finance, Auctions

## Work Experience

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### UW-Madison

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

Fall 2023 - Fall 2025

- Supervisors: Prof. Jean-François Houde and Prof. Kenneth Hendricks

### Stone Payments

ANALYST

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Aug. 2019 - Aug. 2021

- Manager: Prof. Vinicius Carrasco (Chief Economist & Regulatory Affairs Executive Officer, Assistant Professor PUC-Rio)

### PUC-Rio

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Feb. 2019 - Jul. 2019

- Supervisor: Prof. Fabio Miessi

### PUC-Rio

RESEARCH ASSISTANT

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Jan. 2018 - Dec. 2018

- Supervisor: Prof. Leonardo Rezende

### Rio Grande do Sul Development Agency

INTERN (OCT/2011 - JAN/2013), ANALYST (TENURED) (FEB/2013 - DEC/2016)

Porto Alegre, Brazil

Oct. 2011 - Dec. 2016

## Teaching Experience

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### UW-Madison

TEACHING ASSISTANT

Fall 2026

- Course: Econ 468 Industrial Organization and Imperfect Competition (undergraduate)
- Professor: Panle Barwick

### UW-Madison

TEACHING ASSISTANT

Summer 2023

- Course: Econ 521 Game Theory (undergraduate)
- Professor: David Hansen

### UW-Madison

TEACHING ASSISTANT

Spring 2023

- Course: Econ 301 Intermediate Microeconomics (undergraduate) - Avg. 4.75/5.0
- Professor: Rasmus Lentz

### UW-Madison

TEACHING ASSISTANT

Fall 2022

- Course: Econ 521 Game Theory (undergraduate) - Avg. 4.71/5.0
- Professor: Benjamin Bernard

### PUC-Rio

TEACHING ASSISTANT

Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Mar. 2018 - Jul. 2018

- Course: Microeconomics (Professional Masters)
- Course coordinator: Prof. Fabio Miessi

### UFRGS

TEACHING ASSISTANT

Porto Alegre, Brazil

Mar. 2011 - Oct. 2011

- Course: Calculus I (undergraduate)
- Course coordinators: Prof. Elizabeta Gallicchio and Prof. Jaime Ripoll (Department of Mathematics)

## Research

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### WORKING PAPERS

#### Local Content in Brazilian Oil and Gas Auctions

WITH LEONARDO REZENDE (PUC-Rio)

- Conferences: Brazilian Econometric Society 2023, Midwest Economics Association 2024, IIOC 2024

# Honors and Awards

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**Mary Sue and Mike Shannon Dissertation Fellowship**

UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN-MADISON Spring 2027

**Christensen Graduate Fellowship in Empirical Economics**

UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN-MADISON Spring 2026

**Summer Fellowship**

UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN-MADISON Summer 2025

**Distinguished Teaching Assistant**

DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMICS, UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN-MADISON Spring 2023

# Other information

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**Computer Skills**

R, JULIA, GIT, LATEX, SQL

**Languages**

PORTUGUESE (NATIVE), ENGLISH (FLUENT), SPANISH (ADVANCED), FRENCH (INTERMEDIATE)